

HOROLOGICAL MASTER COLLECTION SERIES

PART III

HOROLOGICAL VALUE PORTFOLIO

A Collector's Guide to Mispriced Horology

12 TARGET REFERENCES | CURRENT BUY BANDS | VARIANT DISCIPLINE | COMPLETENESS STRATEGY

Every watch must have a valuation argument.

MARKET THESIS

The current opportunity is not simply that pre-owned watches are cheaper than their pandemic peaks. The more interesting split is that the broad secondary market has normalized while the top collector auction market is extraordinarily strong. Phillips set a record Geneva total in May 2026 and then another record U.S. result in June. That suggests collector capital still exists, but it is becoming more selective and more historically literate.

1. INTRINSIC MERIT

The watch must be genuinely interesting: movement architecture, design, historical significance or a first-of-kind idea.

2. VALUATION GAP

Current secondary pricing must look low relative to the watch's horological content, brand position or historical role.

3. CATALYST

There must be a plausible reason the market could notice: anniversary attention, brand renaissance, neo-vintage re-rating, or collector migration toward distinctive design.

4. EXIT BUYER

We should be able to imagine the sophisticated collector who will want the watch from us five or ten years from now.

THE NON-NEGOTIABLE CAUTION

Watches are illiquid collectibles with high transaction costs, uncertain future demand and no guaranteed return. This guide is a disciplined collecting framework, not a substitute for diversified financial investments. Target prices are watch-price targets before sales tax, import duty, buyer fees or future service.

WHERE I SEE THE MISPRICING

Brand-wide opportunities versus reference-specific opportunities

BRAND / ERA	OPPORTUNITY	SCORE	WHY
Chopard L.U.C	Brand-wide	10/10	Manufacture quality and founding-era L.U.C still trade far below peers.
Breguet	Brand-wide / selective	9.5/10	Prestige-to-price disconnect; favor visually distinctive Tradition and pure Classique.
Girard-Perregaux	Brand-wide / selective	9/10	Deep history, real manufacture capability, weak secondary pricing.
Jaeger-LeCoultre	Reference-specific	8.8/10	Known brand, but some unusual technical references remain oddly cheap.
Ulysse Nardin	Reference-specific	8.7/10	Buy the historical innovations, especially Freak; avoid generic catalog pieces.
Early Roger Dubuis	Era-specific	8.7/10	Collector recognition is accelerating; documentation and scarcity matter enormously.
Neo-vintage Vacheron	Reference-specific	8.5/10	Look away from Overseas toward shaped cases, calendars and power-reserve pieces.
Parmigiani Fleurier	Speculative brand-wide	8.3/10	Huge quality, low liquidity; modern critical success may pull collectors backward.
Early Lange	Reference-specific	8.2/10	Brand is fully respected; early examples can still be underpriced versus importance.
Patek Philippe	Reference-specific	7.8/10	Not undervalued broadly. Hunt first-of-type complications and neglected neo-vintage.

BUY DISCIPLINE & COMPLETENESS

The cheapest example is often not the best investment example.

MODERN / 2000s+ FULL SET STRONGLY PREFERRED	Original papers tie the serial-numbered watch to its sale history and help future liquidity. Buy watch-only only when the discount is obvious.
1990s NEO-VINTAGE PAPERS MATTER; CONDITION STILL WINS	This is the sweet spot where original documents can be scarce enough to matter but common enough that we should not ignore them.
1960s-1980s VINTAGE ORIGINALITY > CARDBOARD	Dial, hands, case geometry, crown, movement correctness and service history outrank boxes. Period boxes can be assembled later.
HIGH COMPLICATION / THIN MARKET DOCUMENTATION IS PART OF THE ASSET	For early Roger Dubuis, Freak, complicated Parmigiani and similar pieces, certificates and service records reduce future buyer anxiety.

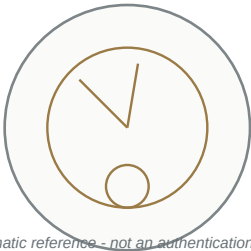
PURCHASE CHECKLIST	
☐ Reference and variant verified	☐ Box / papers strategy satisfied
☐ Serial / movement coherence	☐ Landed cost still inside target band
☐ Case geometry and dial originality	☐ At least two credible exit comparables
☐ Service status and future service cost	☐ No purchase based solely on rarity claims

CHOPARD L.U.C | VALUE CARD 01

10 / 10

L.U.C 1860

16/1860



Schematic reference - not an authentication image

MARKET NOW

\$6K-\$19K asks, with credible examples clustering near \$8K-\$11K

BUY BAND

\$7,500-\$10,000

STRONG BUY <= \$8,500

INVESTMENT THESIS

The first-generation L.U.C proposition: precious metal, micro-rotor manufacture movement, Geneva Seal pedigree and foundational importance for modern Chopard watchmaking, still priced like an ordinary luxury dress watch.

KEY VARIANT / WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Prefer the original 36 mm yellow-gold 16/1860 with caliber 1.96 / 96.01-L lineage, original guilloche dial, correct gold buckle and sharp case. Early full-set examples deserve a premium.

COMPLETENESS

Full set strongly preferred. Watch-only is acceptable at roughly a 15-20% discount if condition is exceptional.

CATALYST

Growing recognition of 1990s high horology and Chopard Manufacture; historically important first-generation L.U.C pieces remain thinly followed.

RISK

Brand identity remains split between jewelry and watchmaking; liquidity is modest.

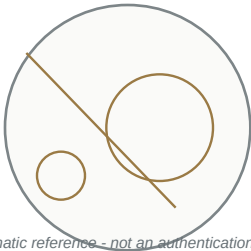
Liquidity: Medium

BREGUET | VALUE CARD 02

9.8 / 10

Tradition 7027

7027BB / 7027BR / 7027BA



Schematic reference - not an authentication image

MARKET NOW

\$13.7K-\$21.5K current asks for standard 7027 variants

BUY BAND

\$14,000-\$17,500

STRONG BUY <= \$15,500

INVESTMENT THESIS

One of the strongest visual and conceptual expressions of modern Breguet. The movement architecture becomes the dial, directly referencing Breguet souscription construction while remaining unmistakably contemporary.

KEY VARIANT / WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Prefer clean early 7027 examples in white or rose gold. Original deployant or pin buckle, intact coin-edge case and complete papers materially improve resale. Avoid heavily polished cases.

COMPLETENESS

Full set strongly preferred because this is modern high horology. Watch-only should be meaningfully cheaper.

CATALYST

Breguet remains a prestige-to-price anomaly; the Tradition line has a much clearer visual identity than generic Classique references.

RISK

Broad Breguet demand remains weak, and retail pricing has historically not translated into secondary strength.

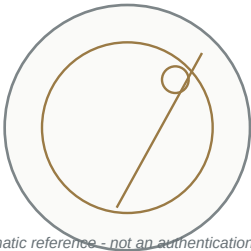
Liquidity: Medium

ULYSSE NARDIN | VALUE CARD 03

9.6 / 10

Freak - first generation

020-88



Schematic reference - not an authentication image

MARKET NOW

Roughly \$29K-\$34K current asks; 25th-anniversary attention has raised visibility

BUY BAND

\$25,000-\$28,000

STRONG BUY <= \$25,500

INVESTMENT THESIS

A genuine modern horological landmark: no conventional dial, hands or crown, a movement that rotates to tell time, and the first luxury watch to deploy silicon in the escapement.

KEY VARIANT / WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Prioritize an early 020-88 with correct bezel-locking system, original clasp, factory service history and no cosmetic restoration. Confirm exact escapement generation.

COMPLETENESS

Papers are highly desirable; service documentation is nearly as important. Full set preferred at this value level.

CATALYST

The Freak turned 25 in 2026 and Ulysse Nardin is actively reasserting the model as a foundational innovation story.

RISK

Complex service, 44.5 mm scale and current re-rating mean the deepest bargain phase may already be passing.

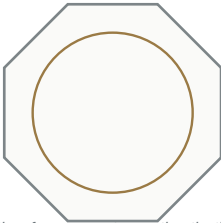
Liquidity: Low-Med

GIRARD-PERREGAUX | VALUE CARD 04

9.4 / 10

Laureato 8010

8010



Schematic reference - not an authentication image

MARKET NOW

\$10.5K-\$19K asks; several realistic examples around \$10.5K-\$13K

BUY BAND

\$9,500-\$12,000

STRONG BUY <= \$10,500

INVESTMENT THESIS

The neo-vintage bridge between the original 1975 Laureato and today: integrated bracelet, compact 36 mm proportions and in-house GP3100 architecture, while the brand remains overshadowed by Royal Oak and Nautilus mythology.

KEY VARIANT / WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Favor all-steel examples with original integrated bracelet and crisp bezel. Gray and blue dials are particularly attractive. Full bracelet length matters more than an aftermarket strap ever will.

COMPLETENESS

Box/papers preferred but bracelet completeness and case condition dominate. Avoid short bracelets unless priced aggressively.

CATALYST

The Laureato celebrated 50 years and GP continues to invest in the line, increasing historical visibility.

RISK

Integrated-bracelet category is crowded; GP remains less liquid than the category leaders.

Liquidity: Medium

JAEGER-LECOULTRE | VALUE CARD 05

9.4 / 10

Geophysic True Second

Q8018420



Reference photograph from the Master Guide asset set

MARKET NOW

\$5.7K-\$8.8K asks, with many examples around \$6.1K-\$7.2K

BUY BAND

\$5,700-\$6,500

STRONG BUY <= \$6,000

INVESTMENT THESIS

A discontinued modern sleeper with intentionally dead-beat seconds, Gyrolab balance and a strong chronometric identity. It is mechanically witty, scarce enough to matter and priced below far more ordinary JLCs.

KEY VARIANT / WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Steel/silver Q8018420. Prefer full set, unpolished case and correct JLC buckle. Avoid paying a large premium for superficial near-new condition.

COMPLETENESS

Full set strongly preferred. At this price level, missing papers should save at least several hundred dollars.

CATALYST

Collectors increasingly reward distinctive technical identity over generic luxury; this reference has that identity in abundance.

RISK

JLC produces many references and does not cultivate scarcity in the same way as smaller independents.

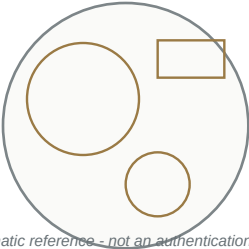
Liquidity: Medium

A. LANGE & SOHNE | VALUE CARD 06

9.3 / 10

Lange 1 - early generation

101.021



Schematic reference - not an authentication image

MARKET NOW

\$22K-\$35K asks; full sets commonly high-\$20Ks to low-\$30Ks

BUY BAND

Watch-only \$22K-\$24.5K | full set \$26K-\$29K

STRONG BUY full set <= \$27K

INVESTMENT THESIS

The defining watch of the modern Lange revival. The market fully respects Lange today, but early Lange 1 examples can still trade at surprisingly modest levels relative to historical importance and finishing.

KEY VARIANT / WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Yellow-gold 101.021 with silver/argent dial and caliber L901.0. Earlier, complete, sharp examples deserve priority. Verify original dial/hands and Lange service history.

COMPLETENESS

Full set has real value. Watch-only can work only when bought at a material discount and with service provenance.

CATALYST

Neo-vintage collecting increasingly focuses on first-generation modern icons and early manufacture eras.

RISK

Already a recognized brand; upside depends on re-rating of early examples rather than discovery of Lange itself.

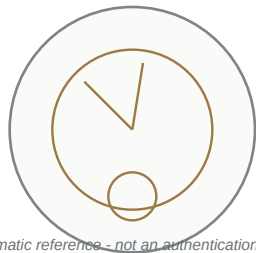
Liquidity: Med-High

BREGUET | VALUE CARD 07

9.0 / 10

Classique 5907

5907BA/12/984



Schematic reference - not an authentication image

MARKET NOW \$9.5K-\$12.9K asks; a full-set example is near \$10K**BUY BAND** **\$9,300-\$10,800**
STRONG BUY <= \$9,800**INVESTMENT THESIS**

A concentrated dose of classical Breguet design and hand-wound watchmaking in 18K gold for roughly the price of many mainstream steel sports watches.

KEY VARIANT / WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Yellow gold, silver guilloché dial, correct Breguet buckle. Inspect fluted case band and soldered lugs carefully for polishing. Manual caliber 511DR condition matters.

COMPLETENESS

Full set preferred, but a sharp watch-only example can be compelling below \$9.5K.

CATALYST

If Breguet broadly re-rates, small, pure Classique references offer inexpensive exposure to the brand DNA.

RISK 34 mm size limits the buyer pool; it lacks the instant visual theater of the Tradition 7027.

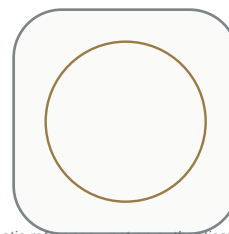
Liquidity: Medium

ROGER DUBUIS | VALUE CARD 08

9.2 / 10

Sympathie Chronograph

S37 56 5



Schematic reference - not an authentication image

MARKET NOW Sparse market; comparable early Sympathie pieces are often \$20K+ and a documented S37 56 5 sold for \$30,240 at Phillips in 2022**BUY BAND** **\$20,000-\$24,000**
STRONG BUY <= \$21,000 full set**INVESTMENT THESIS**

Early Roger Dubuis combines independent-era scarcity, Geneva Seal finishing, observatory chronometer certification and a case shape that no one can mistake for another brand.

KEY VARIANT / WHAT TO LOOK FOR

S37 56 5 pink gold chronograph, ideally one of 28 with original certificate, chronometer bulletin, both casebacks and correct buckle. Documentation is unusually important here.

COMPLETENESS

Full set is close to mandatory for the investment thesis. The certificates are part of what makes early Dubuis collectible.

CATALYST

Collectors are rapidly rediscovering pre-Richemont Roger Dubuis and early independent watchmaking.

RISK Already re-rating, extremely thin market, and reference nomenclature can be confusing. Buy only after detailed verification.

Liquidity: Low

VACHERON CONSTANTIN | VALUE CARD 09

9.1 / 10

Historiques Toledo 1952

47300 family



Reference photograph from prior Master Guide asset set

MARKET NOW

Watch-only yellow-gold examples near \$13.7K; full-set white-gold example around \$19.9K

BUY BAND

Watch-only \$13K-\$15K | full set \$17K-\$19K
STRONG BUY watch-only <= \$14K

INVESTMENT THESIS

The curved Cioccolato case plus complete-calendar architecture gives this watch unmistakable Vacheron identity at a fraction of modern VC complication pricing.

KEY VARIANT / WHAT TO LOOK FOR

47300/000R-9219 rose gold or 47300/000J-9065 yellow gold for value; white gold is stealthier. Prioritize dial integrity, calendar function and case curvature over box.

COMPLETENESS

Full set preferred for neo-vintage, but an excellent watch-only piece at a 20%+ discount can be the sharper buy.

CATALYST

Vacheron demand is broadening beyond Overseas; shaped and historically distinctive dress watches are gaining collector attention.

RISK

Calendar service can be expensive; shaped cases reveal polishing quickly.

Liquidity: Medium

VACHERON CONSTANTIN | VALUE CARD 10

8.8 / 10

Malte Power Reserve / Date

83060/000G-9287 or /000R-9288



Reference photograph from prior Master Guide asset set

MARKET NOW

\$11.5K-\$15K common asks; full-set examples can appear around \$12K

BUY BAND

\$10,500-\$12,500
STRONG BUY full set <= \$11,500

INVESTMENT THESIS

Manual-wind Vacheron in precious metal with power reserve, date, small seconds and serious movement finishing, still priced well below current manufacture equivalents.

KEY VARIANT / WHAT TO LOOK FOR

White gold 83060/000G-9287 for stealth or rose gold /000R-9288 for warmth. Look for guilloché dial, correct gold buckle, clean case edges and recent service.

COMPLETENESS

Full set strongly preferred when the premium is modest. A current-service full set near \$12K is especially attractive.

CATALYST

Neo-vintage Vacheron remains under-followed outside the Overseas and obvious Historiques icons.

RISK

Less visually iconic than Toledo or 1972; resale can take time.

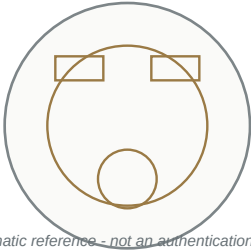
Liquidity: Medium

PATEK PHILIPPE | VALUE CARD 11

8.9 / 10

Annual Calendar

5035 family



Schematic reference - not an authentication image

MARKET NOW

J/G/R examples roughly mid-\$20Ks; platinum commonly high-\$20Ks to low-\$30Ks

BUY BAND

J/G/R \$23K-\$26K | P \$27K-\$30K

STRONG BUY J/G/R <= \$24.5K with papers

INVESTMENT THESIS

The reference family that introduced Patek Philippe annual-calendar wristwatches. Historically consequential, mechanically useful and still inexpensive relative to modern Patek complication pricing.

KEY VARIANT / WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Prefer 5035G or 5035R for stronger modern demand; 5035J is often the cheapest entry. Platinum 5035P is compelling under \$29K. Papers or Extract strongly preferred.

COMPLETENESS

Papers strongly preferred. For Patek, provenance materially affects buyer confidence and liquidity. An Extract helps, but is not equivalent to original papers.

CATALYST

Neo-vintage Patek is increasingly being sorted by historical importance rather than merely age; first-of-type complications can benefit.

RISK

Patek is not an undervalued brand overall, and there are many annual-calendar alternatives competing for attention.

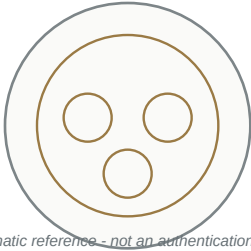
Liquidity: High

PARMIGIANI FLEURIER | VALUE CARD 12

8.6 / 10

Toric Chronograph

Ref. 361 / C00940 family



Schematic reference - not an authentication image

MARKET NOW

\$22.6K-\$29.3K current asks for precious-metal early Toric chronographs

BUY BAND

\$18,000-\$22,000

STRONG BUY <= \$20,000

INVESTMENT THESIS

Early Parmigiani remains one of the deepest quality-to-recognition mismatches in modern Swiss watchmaking. The Toric was the founding design language, and early chronographs pair that identity with the Zenith El Primero base.

KEY VARIANT / WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Look for early rose- or white-gold Toric chronographs with guilloche dial, original Parmigiani gold buckle and documented movement service. Ref. 361 is especially appealing.

COMPLETENESS

Full set strongly preferred because the market is thin. Watch-only should be bought very aggressively.

CATALYST

Parmigiani has gained major modern critical attention; collectors may increasingly work backward into the Michel Parmigiani founding era.

RISK

Low liquidity and complicated reference history. This is an asymmetric collector bet, not a trading watch.

Liquidity: Low

SECONDARY WATCHLIST

Good ideas that did not make the first 12-card portfolio

Vacheron 1972 / Prestige de la France 37010

Watch below \$14K; strong at \$12K or less

Shaped-design thesis is excellent, but exact vintage variant/originality can be difficult to compare.

Chopard L.U.C Quattro 16/1863

Watch below \$14K; strong at \$12K

Nine-day manual-wind architecture is fascinating, but less liquid and visually less iconic than the 1860.

Credor Eichi II

Watch only if low-\$20Ks return

Already increasingly recognized; less obviously mispriced than it was several years ago.

Patek 5000J / early small Calatrava oddities

Opportunistic, reference-specific

Neo-vintage Patek is being rediscovered, but buy only references with a clear story, not merely because they are cheap.

Grand Seiko V.F.A.

Originality-first, no generic target

Historically important, but the market is highly variant-sensitive and top examples can already command serious auction prices.

Early Urban Jurgensen

Research priority

2026 auction results show powerful collector interest. Opportunity remains, but the easy phase may be over.

SOURCES & METHODOLOGY

Pricing is based on a cross-section of current August 2026 dealer/private asks and recent auction evidence rather than a single listing. Buy bands deliberately sit below ordinary dealer asks because transaction costs, servicing and illiquidity must be compensated. Asking prices are not the same as completed-sale prices.

MARKET BACKDROP	Chrono24 ChronoPulse Watch Index; Chrono24 Secondary Watch Market Report H1 2025; Phillips Geneva Watch Auction XXIII (May 2026); Phillips Asia Spring 2026 Market Report.
CHOPARD L.U.C 1860	Chopard official L.U.C Manufacture history; Chrono24 ref. 16/1860 listings, accessed Aug. 2026.
BREGUET TRADITION / CLASSIQUE	Chrono24 Tradition 7027 and Classique 5907 listings, accessed Aug. 2026.
ULYSSE NARDIN FREAK	Ulysse Nardin official Freak 2001 history and silicon-technology archive; Chrono24 ref. 020-88 listings, accessed Aug. 2026.
GIRARD-PERREGAUX LAUREATO	Girard-Perregaux official manufacture history and Laureato timeline; Chrono24 ref. 8010 listings, accessed Aug. 2026.
JAEGER-LECOULTRE GEOPHYSIC	Chrono24 Q8018420 listings, accessed Aug. 2026; JLC historical/technical material cross-checked from prior Swiss Artisans guide research.
A. LANGE & SOHNE LANGE 1	Chrono24 ref. 101.021 listings, accessed Aug. 2026.
ROGER DUBUIS SYMPATHIE	Phillips New York Watch Auction Seven, lot for ref. S37 56 5; Phillips Hong Kong Sympathie cataloguing; Chrono24 early Sympathie/Hommage listings.
VACHERON CONSTANTIN	Chrono24 47300 and 83060 listings, accessed Aug. 2026; historical context cross-checked to prior Swiss Artisans guide research.
PATEK PHILIPPE 5035	Chrono24 5035J/G/R/P listings, accessed Aug. 2026.
PARMIGIANI FLEURIER TORIC	Chrono24 Toric and ref. 361 / C00940 listings, accessed Aug. 2026; brand-history context from Parmigiani market references.

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

Treat every price as a trigger for deeper diligence, not an automatic buy signal. Before purchase, refresh the live market, inspect exact-condition comparables, confirm reference/variant details, calculate landed cost, and price in a realistic service reserve. A watch can be underpriced historically and still be a poor purchase if the specimen is wrong.